

wcommand[1]

—*The Grey Wanderer: 1*

wcommand[1]

—*Saikou Ira: 1*

wcommand[1]

—*Dusana: 1*

wcommandrrisblock[1]

—*L. Fenwood: 1*

eadrulewidth0.4pt

þispagestyleempty

The Witnessed Prey

Large A Bestiary of Debts, Flesh, and Thresholds

A Fate's Edge Expansion

Compiled by Lerris Fenwood

Fifth Son of Duke Braedon Fenwood, Scholar of Thepyrgos,
Secret Member of the Congregation of the Unmasking

Under the lamp, bread and salt the ink is witness and ash.

20pt A Note on Method and Madness

tshape

The truth does not kill the vampire; the silver does.

Saikou Ira

This compendium is not a catalogue of trophies. It is a ledger of debts. Every creature herein owes something to a patron, to the Hollow, to a broken oath, or to the silence that follows a miscount. I have walked the stairs of Thepyrgos, the fog of the Mistlands, and the violet steppe; I have spoken with ghosts, bound spirits, and once, briefly, with a Trow who offered to sell me my own shadow. I offered another trade. I am still paying for that conversation.

You will find no challenge ratings here. You will find no tidy bags of experience. Instead, each entry offers a hunger, a witness, a weakness, and a timer. The rest is negotiation.

I have been aided or afflicted by three companions who insisted on scribbling in the margins. The Grey Wanderer, who has worn more faces than I have shirts; Saikou Ira, whose silver mirror never lies; and Dusana of the Raven Road, who pays her debts in stories. Their voices will appear unbidden. Ignore them at your peril.

If you are reading this, you are now a witness. The creatures within are real. They are hungry. They are waiting. But so are we.

Lerris Fenwood

Thepyrgos, under the Ninth Bell (which did not ring)

A fine beginning, scholar. But you forgot to mention that the ninth bell never rings for the living. I've heard it twice. Trust me, you don't want to be the third.

The first creature you should catalogue is your own certainty. I lost mine in a Sidhi lighthouse, and I've been sharper for it ever since.

A ledger of stories is a ledger of hope. This one is full of teeth. I'll add a few of my own.

Let them talk. The work remains.

^{20pt} Contents

^{20pt} Mortal Adversaries

putchapters/chapter1.tex

^{20pt} The Unquiet Dead

putchapters/chapter2.tex

^{20pt}The Cursed Corrupted

putchapters/chapter3.tex

^{20pt}The Cursed Corrupted

putchapters/chapter4.tex

^{20pt}Beasts of the Wilds

putchapters/chapter5.tex

^{20pt}Fae Threshold Spirits

putchapters/chapter6.tex

^{20pt}Epic Unique Bosses

putchapters/chapter7.tex

20pt Adversary Templates Quick Generators

putchapters/chapter8.tex

^{20pt}Appendix: Tools Tables

putchapters/appendix.tex

20pt Colophon

tshape

The ink is ash. The mirror is clean. The debt is never closed.

Saikou Ira

This book was written on paper that had been a cargo manifest, a love letter, and a bandage. The ink is lampblack cut with salt water and the ash of a burnt confession. The binding is grey cord tied with nine knots. The ninth knot is not cut.

The Grey Wanderer contributed his usual cynicism and a recipe for tea that keeps the Hollow from your doorstep (mostly). Saikou Ira insisted on keeping a silver mirror beside the writing desk; it fogged exactly twice, and he will not say what he saw. Dusana sang a lark into the rafters; the bird stayed for three days and left a single feather, which I have pressed between these pages.

As for me, Lerris Fenwood, I have seen the faces of the Unmasked. I have read the true ledger of the Congregation. I have learned that the ninth name is never spoken because it belongs to the one who will speak it last. When that day comes, I hope this book serves as witness.

Until then, the road is south. The ink is fresh. The lamp is borrowed.

Lerris Fenwood

Thepyrgos, in the hour before dawn

You forgot to mention the bread. Always leave bread for the threshold.

And a coin for the ferryman, just in case.

And a story for the fire. The rest will take care of itself.

rrisblockPaid in full.